



Operations Research

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Exercise Sheet 4

Training Exercises

Exercise T4.1. Duality & Complementary Slackness

a) Derive the dual LP from the following LP.

$$\begin{aligned}
 (P) \quad & \underset{\text{s.t.}}{\text{Min}} && 2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 - x_4 \\
 & && -x_1 + x_2 + 2x_3 - x_4 \geq 15 \\
 & && x_1 - x_2 + 4x_4 = 5 \\
 & && 2x_2 - 2x_3 + x_4 \leq -15 \\
 & && x_1, x_2, x_3 \geq 0 \\
 & && x_4 \leq 0
 \end{aligned}$$

b) Let $x^T = (5, 0, 10, 0)$ be a primal point. Use the complementary slackness conditions to check whether x is an optimal solution for (P) .

Exercise T4.2. Duality

Consider the following linear programs, with $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ and $b, c \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

$$\begin{array}{ll}
 (P_1) \underset{\text{s.t.}}{\max} & c^T x \\
 & Ax = b \\
 & x \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^n \\
 (P_3) \underset{\text{s.t.}}{\min} & b^T x \\
 & A^T x \geq c \\
 & x \in \mathbb{R}^n \\
 (P_2) \underset{\text{s.t.}}{\min} & c^T x \\
 & Ax = b \\
 & x \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^n \\
 (P_4) \underset{\text{s.t.}}{\max} & b^T x \\
 & A^T x = c \\
 & x \in \mathbb{R}^n
 \end{array}$$

Let z_1, z_2, z_3 and z_4 be the optimal objective function values of $(P_1), (P_2), (P_3)$ and (P_4) respectively.

- Determine the corresponding dual linear program for each of the above programs. Identify primal-dual pairs among the linear programs $(P_1) - (P_4)$.
- Show that if $(P_1), (P_2), (P_3), (P_4)$ are feasible, then $z_1 = z_2 = z_3 = z_4$.
- If $z_1 > z_2$, which linear program cannot be feasible? Explain your answer.

Exercise T4.3. *Rock-Paper-Scissors*

George and Max play rock-paper-scissors. The rules are simple: both players simultaneously choose a symbol from the set {Scissors, Rock, Paper}. Scissors beats paper, paper beats rock and rock beats scissors. If both players choose the same symbol, the round ends in a draw. The winner of each round receives 2 euros from the loser. In the case of a draw, no money is exchanged.

- a) Build the payoff matrix of this game for Max and George.
- b) Model the problem of finding an optimal strategy for George and Max as a linear program. State the optimal strategy and the win/loss for both players.
- c) Max proposes the following change to George. In the event of a tie, George receives 1.5 euros from Max if rock or scissors was played. If paper was played, Max receives 3 euros from George. Determine the optimal strategies for this modified problem. Should George accept the proposal? Justify your answer.

Hint: Use Gurobi to solve the LPs.

Self-study Exercises

Exercise S4.1. *Duality*

$$\begin{array}{ll}
 (P) \text{ Max } & x_1 + x_2 \\
 \text{s.t.} & \\
 & -3x_1 + 2x_2 \leq -1 \\
 & x_1 - x_2 \leq 2 \\
 & x_1, x_2 \geq 0
 \end{array}$$

- a) Formulate the corresponding dual LP to (P)
- b) List all complementary slackness conditions of these LPs.
- c) Does the primal LP have feasible solutions? Justify your answer.
- d) Is the primal LP bounded? Justify your answer.

Exercise S4.2. *Duality & Complementary Slackness*

- a) Derive the dual LP (D) from the following LP:

$$\begin{array}{ll}
 (P) \text{ Max } & 15x_1 + 5x_2 - 15x_3 \\
 \text{s.t.} & \\
 & -x_1 + x_2 \leq 2 \\
 & x_1 - x_2 + 2x_3 \leq 2 \\
 & 2x_1 - 2x_3 \leq 2 \\
 & -x_1 + 4x_2 + x_3 \geq -1 \\
 & x_1 \geq 0 \\
 & x_3 \leq 0
 \end{array}$$

- b) State all complementary slackness conditions.
- c) Let $y^r = (9, 0, 16, -1)$ be a dual point. Use the complementary slackness conditions to check whether y is an optimal solution for (D) .
- d) Let $x^r = (1, 3, 0)$ be a primal point. Use the complementary slackness conditions to check whether x is an optimal solution for (P) .